Problem #5: Japanese Compound Words (20 marks)

In Japanese, certain root words undergo a change at their left edge when they form compound words under specific circumstances. This phenomenon is traditionally called *Rendaku*. Examine the following examples of Japanese compound words:

Japanese words	Compound word	Gloss	Meaning
hito* + *hito	***hitobito***	person + person	people
ike* + *hana	***ikebana***	keep alive + flower	flower arrangement
toki* + *toki	***tokidoki***	time + time	sometimes
te* + *kami	***tegami***	hand + paper	letter
hitori* + *tabi	***hitoritabi***	one person + travel	travelling alone
tsuno* + *tokage	***tsunotokage***	horn + lizard	horned lizard
yama* + *kawa	***yamakawa***	mountains + rivers	mountains and rivers
aka* + *huda	***akahuda***	red + tag	red tag
maki* + *susi	***makizusi***	rolling + sushi#	rolled sushi
yama* + *kawa	***yamagawa***	mountain + river	mountain's river
hebi* + *tosi	***hebidosi***	snake + year	snake year
eda* + *ha	***edaha***	branches + leaves	branches and leaves
oo* + *kaze	***ookaze***	big + wind	big wind
kokoro* + *tsukai	***kokorodzukai***	heart + using	anxiety
denki* + *kurage	***denkikurage***	electric + jellyfish	electric jellyfish
yuki* + *kaeri	***yukikaeri***	coming + going	coming and going
hana* + *sono	***hanazono***	flower + garden	flower garden
nise* + *karasu	***nisegarasu***	fake + crow	fake crow

Assignment 1:
Fill in the following compound words.

Japanese words	Compound word	Gloss	Meaning
wa* + *kasi	_____	Japanese + cake	Japanese cake
yama* + *kazi	_____	mountain + fire	forest fire
juzu* + *tsunagi	_____	rosary + sequence	roping together
yama* + *tera	_____	mountain + temple	mountain temple
ao* + *kawazu	_____	green + frog	green frog
uwa* + *huta	_____	top + lid	top lid
e* + *tako	_____	picture + kite	picture kite

Assignment 2:
When compounds are made up of more than two words, things become truly interesting. Fill in the blank entries (A to E) in the following Table:

Japanese words	Compound Word	Gloss	Meaning
hosi-kaki-tsukuri	***hosi-gaki-dzukuri***	dried persimmon* making	making dried persimmon
nise-kami-tana	***nise-kami-dana***	fake divine altar	a divine altar that is fake
nise-kami-tana	***nise-gami-dana***	fake divine altar	an altar for a fake God
ori-kami-tana	***ori-gami-tana***	fold paper shelf	origami shelf
nise-sakura-dayori	***A. ?***	fake cherry-blossom tidings	tidings of fake cherry-blossoms
nise-sakura-dayori	***nise-sakura-dayori***	fake cherry-blossom tidings	fake tidings of

			cherry-blossoms
nuri-hasi-hako	***B. ?***	lacquered chopstick box	a box for lacquered chopsticks
nuri-hasi-hako	***nuri-hasi-bako***	lacquered chopstick box	a lacquered box for chopsticks
nise-tanuki-siru	***C. ?***	pseudo tanuki** soup	soup made from pseudo tanuki
nise-tanuki-siru	***D. ?***	pseudo tanuki soup	tanuki soup that is not authentic
oya-ko-kenka	***E. ?***	parent child quarrel	parent and child quarrel

Japanese is spoken by about 125 million speakers primarily in Japan.
#**sushi** is cooked vinegared rice combined usually with raw fish.
***persimmon** is a fruit.
****tanuki** is Japanese raccoon dog.

- *Zarana Sarda*